

Integrations

Xcode

Xcode 26.3+ exposes a built-in MCP server that gives Cursor direct access to your Xcode projects. Cursor's agent can read and edit files, trigger builds, run tests, capture SwiftUI previews, and search Apple's documentation; all without leaving your editor.

This works through `xcrun mcpbridge`, a binary Apple ships with Xcode that translates MCP protocol messages into Xcode's internal XPC layer. You configure it once, and Cursor treats Xcode's 20 built-in tools like any other MCP server.

Prerequisites

- macOS with Xcode 26.3 or later installed
- A paid [Cursor plan](#)
- An Xcode project open in Xcode (Xcode must be running)

Enable MCP in Xcode

Before Cursor can connect, turn on Xcode's MCP bridge:

1 Open Xcode settings

Go to **Xcode > Settings > Intelligence**.

2 Enable MCP

Under **Model Context Protocol**, toggle **Xcode Tools** on.

Set up Cursor

Pick whichever method suits your workflow.

Option 1: MCP settings UI

1 Open MCP settings

Go to **Cursor Settings > Features > MCP**.

2 Add the server

Click **Add New MCP Server**. Set the transport to **stdio**, name it `xcode-tools`, and enter `xcrun mcpbridge` as the command.

Option 2: `mcp.json`

Add an entry to your [MCP config file](#):

```
~/ .cursor/mcp.json
```

```
1 {
2   "mcpServers": {
3     "xcode-tools": {
```

```
4     "command": "xcrun",
5     "args": ["mcpbridge"]
6   }
7 }
8 }
```

Option 3: Cursor CLI

If you use the [Cursor CLI](#), register the server from your terminal:

```
agent mcp add xcode-tools -- xcrun mcpbridge
```

The CLI shares the same MCP config as the editor, so the server appears in both.

Available tools

Xcode exposes 20 MCP tools across five categories:

File operations

- **XcodeRead** - Read file contents (up to 600 lines per call, with offset/limit for larger files)
- **XcodeWrite** - Create or overwrite files
- **XcodeUpdate** - Apply targeted edits to existing files
- **XcodeGrep** - Search file contents with regex
- **XcodeGlob** - Find files by pattern
- **XcodeLS** - List directory contents
- **XcodeMakeDir** - Create directories
- **XcodeRM** - Remove files or directories
- **XcodeMV** - Move or rename files

Build and test

- **BuildProject** - Build the active scheme
- **GetBuildLog** - Retrieve build logs, filterable by severity, regex, or file glob
- **RunAllTests** - Run the full test suite
- **RunSomeTests** - Run specific test classes or methods
- **GetTestList** - List available tests

Diagnostics

- **XcodeListNavigatorIssues** - Show warnings and errors from the Issue Navigator
- **XcodeRefreshCodeIssuesInFile** - Re-check a file for code issues

Intelligence

- **RenderPreview** - Capture a screenshot of a SwiftUI preview
- **DocumentationSearch** - Semantic search across Apple's documentation and WWDC transcripts
- **ExecuteSnippet** - Run a Swift code snippet

Workspace

- **XcodeListWindows** - List open Xcode windows and tabs

Example workflow

A typical Cursor + Xcode workflow looks like this:

1. Open your project in both Cursor and Xcode

- 2. Ask Cursor's agent to add a feature or fix a bug
- 3. The agent uses **XcodeRead** and **XcodeGrep** to understand your code
- 4. It edits files with **XcodeWrite** or **XcodeUpdate**
- 5. It runs **BuildProject** to check for errors, reads results with **GetBuildLog**
- 6. It runs tests with **RunSomeTests** to verify the change
- 7. It captures a SwiftUI preview with **RenderPreview** to confirm the UI

You stay in Cursor the whole time. Xcode handles compilation, testing, and previews in the background.

Cursor CLI with Xcode

The [Cursor CLI](#) also works with Xcode's MCP tools. This is useful for headless workflows, CI pipelines, or terminal-first developers.

```
1 # Run agent with Xcode tools available
2 agent "Add unit tests for the NetworkManager class"
```

The agent picks up the `xcode-tools` MCP server from your config and uses the same tools available in the editor.

Troubleshooting

Cursor can't find the xcode-tools server	▼
Tools show errors about missing tabIdentifier	▼
Build or test tools time out	▼
MCP toggle missing in Xcode settings	▼
xcrun: error: unable to find utility "mcpbridge"	▼

Related

 MCP overview Complete MCP guide with setup, configuration, and authentication	 iOS & macOS (Swift) Swift development workflow with Cursor, Sweetpad, and Xcode Build Server
 Cursor CLI Use Cursor's agent from the terminal	 CLI MCP commands Manage MCP servers from the command line